SABAH

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ABOUT

Sabah, Best of Borneo

Situated on the beautiful island of Borneo, Sabah is one of the thirteen states which Malaysia is made of. Sabah is the second largest state in Malaysia and shares the island of Borneo with Sarawak, Brunei, and Indonesian Kalimantan. Sabah is richly blessed with nature diversity, unique cultures, fun adventure, beautiful beaches, and fantastic cuisines for the adventurous taste buds.

We have it all, from the world's largest flower — the Rafflesia, one of the highest mountains in South East Asia — Mount Kinabalu, to one of the world's top dive sites — Sipadan Island. Sabah is also known for great natural treasures which include the world-renowned Danum Valley Conservation Area and Tabin which is Sabah's largest wildlife reserve.

Not only will you be amazed by the places to see and things to do here, you will also be treated with unique Sabahan hospitality. Explore the unique culture and tradition of Sabah and get ready to experience sweet memories to last a lifetime!



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Discover

FOOD & BEVERAGES

FOOD & BEVERAGES

Hinava | Latok | Nasi Linopot | Ambuyat | Bambangan | Bosou (Noonsom) | Ngiu Chap | Midin | Pinasakan | Sagol | Tarap

Sabah's food reflects the amazing diversity of its people and landscapes. With over 30 ethnic groups, Sabah's cuisine blends Kadazan-Dusun, Bajau, Murut, Bruneian Malay, Chinese and indigenous influences. Popular dishes like **hinava**, **tuaran mee** and **ngiu chap** showcase flavours unique to the state.

Fresh ingredients play a big role in Sabah's cooking—from Kundasang's mountain vegetables to the daily seafood catch from Kota Kinabalu, Kudat and Semporna. Traditional dishes such as bambangan, tuhau and linopot feature natural herbs and preserved fruits, while coastal communities offer favourites like ambuyat, sinalau bakas and charcoal-grilled seafood.

To experience Sabah's food culture, visit local tamu markets, seafood villages or cafés known for handmade noodles. Every meal captures the state's rich heritage, making Sabah a growing hotspot for food lovers.





For veggie lovers

Healthy eating is becoming increasingly popular in Sabah, thanks to the abundance of fresh local produce and traditional ingredients like wild ginger, mountain vegetables and sago-based dishes. Vegetarians will find plenty to enjoy, from plant-based versions of local favourites such as linopot, ambuyat, tuaran mee sayur and vegetarian ngiu chap.

Organic cafés and vegan-friendly eateries are growing in Kota Kinabalu and major towns, offering hearty meals inspired by both modern cuisine and traditional Bornean cooking.



Explore

LIFESTYLE & LOCAL CULTURE

LIFESTYLE & LOCAL CULTURE

Traditional Music | Handicrafts | Languages | Traditional Dress | Dance & Performance

Sabah's culture is a living tapestry woven from over 30 ethnic groups — each contributing music, ritual, craft and food that shape daily life. From the colourful tamu markets to mountain settlements and coastal villages, local customs remain visible in how people celebrate, farm, trade and care for community life.

Community and kinship play a central role: traditional institutions, craft knowledge and seasonal festivals connect generations. Visitors will find rich traditions such as storytelling, rice-harvesting ceremonies, bamboo and rattan weaving, gong music and vibrant festival attire. The state's languages and oral histories continue to be an essential part of identity and cultural resilience.

To experience Sabah's culture, visit a tamu market at dawn, join a local festival, learn craft techniques from artisans or attend a community ceremony. These interactions give a deeper understanding of everyday life and the values that sustain local communities.



Preserving traditions

Local NGOs, cultural centres and community elders are actively documenting languages, dances and craft techniques. Sustainable tourism initiatives encourage respectful visits where visitors support local economies and cultural preservation — from buying handmade crafts to attending community-led workshops.

Whether you're interested in crafts, ceremonies, or daily life, Sabah's living culture offers responsible ways to learn, participate and contribute.



Explore

NATURE & ADVENTURE

NATURE & ADVENTURE

Hiking & Trails | Islands & Beaches | Diving & Marine | Mount Kinabalu | Rivers & Wildlife | Caves & Karst | Parks & Reserves

Sabah is an adventurer's playground — from misty mountain summits and mossy cloud forests to coral gardens and mangrove-lined rivers. Whether you seek high-altitude challenges, wildlife encounters or crystal-clear dive sites, Sabah offers world-class nature experiences.

Hiking options range from short nature walks to multi-day treks up Mount Kinabalu. The marine sites around Semporna and Sipadan are internationally renowned for diving. River safaris along the Kinabatangan give opportunities to spot proboscis monkeys, orangutans and diverse birdlife. For spelunkers, limestone caves around Madai and Gomantong are fascinating.

Plan trips with local guides who know the terrain and conservation rules. Respect protected areas, follow Leave No Trace principles, and support community-based tourism to ensure ecosystems remain healthy and local communities benefit.



Quick tips

Best time: Dry season (March–October) is generally better for trekking and diving, though specific areas vary.

Guides & permits: Mount Kinabalu requires permits and certified guides; some marine parks require dive permits or conservation fees.

Safety

Always check local weather, carry adequate water, and inform guides of any medical needs. For wildlife viewing, keep a safe distance and never feed animals.

Conservation

Support responsible operators who follow sustainable practices: reef-safe sunscreen, no single-use plastics, and respectful wildlife viewing.

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Explore
TRAVEL
PLACES
SABAH

TRAVEL PLACES

Kinabalu Park | Kundasang | Islands & Semporna | Sipadan | Sandakan & Sepilok | Kinabatangan River | Tawau & Tawau Hills

Sabah is a destination of contrasts — from bustling cities and lively markets to remote rainforests and world-class dive sites. Whether you're planning a short stay in Kota Kinabalu or an extended nature expedition, this selection highlights the must-visit places across the state.

Kota Kinabalu (KK)

KK is Sabah's gateway: seafood markets, waterfront promenades, island day-trips and easy access to Kinabalu Park. Great base for trips, with a growing café scene and cultural attractions.

Kinabalu Park & Kundasang

World Heritage-listed Kinabalu Park is home to Mount Kinabalu and diverse flora. Nearby Kundasang offers scenic farms and cool highland air — ideal for acclimatisation and local produce markets.

Semporna & the Islands

Semporna is the jumping-off point for Sipadan, Mabul and surrounding islands. Book dives and island stays through



Practical tips

Transport: Domestic flights link KK, Sandakan and Tawau; ferries/boats serve island routes. Road travel can be slow—allow time between destinations.

Permits & bookings

Some sites (Mount Kinabalu, Sipadan) require advance permits and booked guides. Plan ahead during peak months to secure permits and accommodation.

Health & safety

Bring insect repellent, sun protection and water purification if heading remote. For jungle treks, travel with licensed guides and inform your lodge of your itinerary.

Respect local culture

Ask before photographing people, dress respectfully at cultural sites, and learn a few local greetings to enrich interactions.